

Podcast Launch Checklist

The order Mat Davenport used to go from zero to a live show, then real growth. Tick each step. The sequence matters.

2.8M MONTHLY VIEWS	13.1K FOLLOWERS	\$0 SPENT ON ADS	3 EPS ON DAY ONE
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HOW TO USE

Work in order. Tick the box when done. Don't skip ahead. "Mat did this" notes are real steps from the Edge Within launch, not theory. Use with the free Playbook and, if you're in it, the full mentorship course (Module 6).

1 Decide Steps 1-8	2 Set up Steps 9-16	3 Record & launch Steps 17-24	4 Grow Steps 25-30
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"I started with zero. No show, no audience, no brand. Back garden under trees. This is the order I wish I'd had written down from day one."

Mat Davenport · @edgewithinpodcast

PHASE 1 · DECIDE & DEFINE

☐ 01

Get clear on why you're really doing this

Not "to grow an audience." Write one honest sentence. If you can't, stay here until you can. Clarity comes before the camera.

☐ 02

Lock your show concept

Broad enough for anyone, specific enough for the right listener. Ask: who would choose this with their limited attention?

☐ 03

Name the show

Short. Means something. Say "Welcome to [name]" out loud ten times. If it feels forced, keep going.

MAT DID THIS

Edge Within came from the idea that growth lives inside you.

☐ 04

Write your one-line mission

One line anyone gets instantly. It becomes your bio, caption opener, and show intro.

☐ 05

Study 3 shows in your space (find the gap)

Not to copy. What's working? What feels scripted? Your edge is what others won't do.

☐ 06

Define your episode format

Pick one format and stick with it for at least 10 episodes. Example: one guest, 45-90 min, unscripted, straight in.

☐ 07

Write down your posting commitment

Example: 1 full episode per week + 3-5 short clips. Consistency beats volume. Write the numbers down.

☐ 08

List your first 5 guests

Start with people you already know. First episodes need real conversations, not famous names.

MAT DID THIS

First three episodes: people I already knew. Honest over impressive.

PHASE 2 · SET UP

☐ 09

Choose a recording setup you can start with

A full studio is nice. An iPhone in good light this week beats waiting six months for gear. The conversation is the product.

☐ 10

Find your recording location

Quiet, decent light, low echo. Test 30 seconds of audio before episode one.

MAT DID THIS

First episodes: back garden under trees for shade. Natural light, no echo.

☐ 11

Set up hosting

Buzzsprout, Podbean, Spotify for Podcasters, or similar. Get distribution to Spotify and Apple sorted before you need it.

☐ 12

Create the show Instagram

Clean handle. Bio = mission line. Profile = show logo. You're building a brand, not a personal spam account.

☐ 13

Cover art and logo

Bold, simple, readable as a tiny thumbnail. Don't over-design. High contrast wins.

☐ 14

Editing tools ready

Premiere, Resolve, CapCut, whatever you'll actually open. Don't let software become the excuse not to start.

☐ 15

Storage plan

Raw video is huge. External drive or cloud before episode one, not after the card fills up mid-edit.

☐ 16

Build a bank before you launch

Record 3-5 episodes before going public. Launch with depth, not a single lonely episode.

MAT DID THIS

Three episodes recorded before posting anything. Consistency from day one.

PHASE 3 · RECORD & LAUNCH

☐ 17

Book your first 3 guests

Simple ask: you're launching, they'd be a great early guest, you'll handle everything. People say yes more than you think.

☐ 18

Prep a direction, not a script

5-10 anchors max. Research what they care about. Best moments are never planned.

☐ 19

Pre-record ritual (state over scripts)

Even two minutes of intentional breathing changes the room. Help your guest arrive before you hit record.

MAT DID THIS

Breathwork with the guest before almost every episode.

☐ 20

Record episodes 1-3

Episode one is never your best. It's proof you started. Get to episode two.

MAT DID THIS

First location: back garden. Good enough is good enough.

☐ 21

Edit the long-form

Cut dead air and energy drops. Don't sterilise it. Natural pauses feel human.

☐ 22

Pull 3-5 clips per episode

Growth lives here. Look for strong opinions, surprise, emotion. One episode can feed a week of posts.

☐ 23

Write captions that extend the clip

Don't describe the video. Open with a hook, add 2-3 lines of thought, tag the guest, clear CTA.

☐ 24

Launch: drop multiple episodes, not one

Three episodes on day one signals a real show. Soft launch to close people first if you want, then go public.

MAT DID THIS

Three episodes live on 20 Jan 2026. Arrival, not a test.

PHASE 4 · GROW

☐ 25

Post consistently when it feels pointless

3-5 posts a week. Quiet early days are normal. Momentum comes after the boring stretch.

MAT DID THIS

444 followers felt like shouting into nothing. Then it compounded.

☐ 26

Tag guests and make sharing easy

Every guest share puts you in front of people who already trust them. Free reach. Never skip it.

☐ 27

Expand guest outreach beyond your network

Lead with something specific about them. Offer a real conversation, not a favour. After 5-8 episodes, the show is your proof.

☐ 28

Review what worked every week

Which clips landed? Which fell flat? Month six should look different from month one because you paid attention.

☐ 29

Build a simple media kit when numbers are real

Even modest stats tell a story. One page is enough to start conversations. No need to wait for 100K.

☐ 30

Don't stop. The work compounds.

Every episode makes the next guest easier and the next post smarter. Protect quality. Keep going.

MAT DID THIS

Slow start, then exponential. The only gap is time and consistency.

You're ready.

Start today. The only difference between zero and a live show is time, order, and consistency.

Day 0 0 followers · 3 episodes	Now 13.1K followers · 2.8M views · \$0 ads
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WANT HELP BUILDING THIS?

Free: The Edge Within Playbook (Notion) via edgewithinpodcast.com/get-playbook
Mentorship: Foundations or Accelerator at edgewithinpodcast.com/mentorship
DM @edgewithinpodcast

V1 course alignment: Module 6 · Launch & First 30 Days · File ID 6.2-pre-launch-checklist